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Strategy

Strategic Management Journal

1. Knowledge protection and modularity of innovation activities in firms: Evidence from US trade secrecy law

Authors: Eunkwang Seo, Christopher P. Dinkel
DOI: 10.1002/smj.70125
Published: 2026-09-10

Keywords: difference-in-differences, human capital, innovation, inventor collaboration, knowledge protection, modularity, trade secrecy law

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Strategic Management, Innovation Management, Intellectual Property, Organizational Design
- **Theories:** Appropriability Theory, Modularity Theory, Network Theory, Knowledge-Based View

Abstract:

Research Summary: Strategy scholars have theoreti- cally explored the relationship between legal knowledge protection and modularity of innovation activities in firms, but this relationship has yet to be empirically tested in the literature. Leveraging state-level changes in US trade secrecy law and using a network modularity measure, this paper examines how trade secret protec- tion affects the modularity of firms' innovation activities. Analyzing intrafirm inventor collaboration patterns in US patent data from 783 high-tech firms between 1976 and 2017, we find that increased trade secret protection is negatively associated with the modularity of innova- tion activities within firms. This effect is more pro- nounced for firms with superior technologies and those geographically collocated with competitors—factors that enhance firms' knowledge appropriability concerns—and less pronounced for firms in industries where alter- native appropriability mechanisms are highly effective. Moreover, our findings suggest that the increased betweenness centrality of new hires (skilled and junior) serves as an important underlying mechanism for the Received: 27 January 2025 Revised: 12 August 2026 Accepted: 21 August 2026 DOI: 10.1002/smj.70125 © 2026 John Wiley & Sons Ltd. All rights reserved, including rights for text and data mining and training of artificial intelligence technologies or similar technologies. Strat Mgmt J. 2026;1–26. wileyonlinelibrary.com/journal/smj 1 treatment effect. These results contribute to the literature by illuminating how firms strategize their internal inno- vation activities for knowledge protection and by unde- rscoring its underlying mechanism. Managerial Summary: Firms often modularize inno- vation activities to safeguard proprietary knowledge, but this approach can undermine innovation perfor- mance by restricting knowledge integration within organizations. This study demonstrates that stronger legal mechanisms alleviating firms' knowledge protec- tion concerns, such as increased trade secret protection, encourage firms to adopt a less modularized, more inte- grated innovation system. Furthermore, we find that under such protections, firms are more likely to posi- tion new hires, including both skilled and junior employees, in central roles to connect innovation com- munities within the organization. These findings offer valuable insights for managers, illustrating how knowl- edge protection concerns can shape the structure of firms' innovation activities. K E Y W O R D S difference-in-differences, human capital, innovation, inventor collaboration, knowledge protection, modularity, trade secrecy law 1 |

 Seo - Knowledge protection and modularity of innovation activities in firms Evidence f.pdf

2. Strategic search: Adaptation of internal fit and market positioning under competition

Authors: Gianluigi Giustiziero, Aseem Kaul, Dirk Martignoni
DOI: 10.1002/smj.70122
Published: 2026-09-04

Keywords: competition, internal fit, market disruption, market positioning, NK model

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Strategic Management, Competitive Strategy, Organizational Search

- **Theories:** NK Landscape Model, Behavioral Theory of the Firm, Cournot Competition, Resource-Based View

Abstract:

Research Summary: Firms seeking competitive advantage need both internal fit and a distinctive mar- ket position, yet strategy research says little about how the search for the two is related. We develop a model of strategic search that integrates an NK landscape with differentiated Cournot competition, allowing a firm's position to shape both its internal fit and distinctive- ness. We show that, under low complexity, competition constrains search, locking firms into resource configu- rations and creating a trade-off between internal fit and distinctiveness. Conversely, under high-complexity competition drives distant search, so that internal fit and distinctiveness go hand-in-hand. We further show that competitive lock-in constrains search by early leaders, while distant search drives the emergence of new leaders, thus offering a search-based theory of market disruption. Managerial Summary: How does the search for oper- ationally effective configurations of resources and Received: 21 March 2022 Revised: 8 August 2026 Accepted: 14 August 2026 DOI: 10.1002/smj.70122 This is an open access article under the terms of the Creative Commons Attribution License, which permits use, distribution and reproduction in any medium, provided the original work is properly cited. © 2026 The Author(s). Strategic Management Journal published by John Wiley & Sons Ltd. Strat Mgmt J. 2026;1–29. wileyonlinelibrary.com/journal/smj 1 capabilities affect the distinctiveness of a firm's offering, and vice versa? Our work suggests that the need for dis- tinctiveness may constrain search close to rivals but also enable the discovery of effective configurations far away from them. In relatively simple environments, where firms tend to converge on the same relatively obvious configurations, the search for distinctiveness is constraining, but in more complex environments it may enable the discovery of superior configurations. Further, early leaders may be constrained in their sea- rch as rivals cluster around them, while early followers may benefit more from distant search, potentially lead- ing to a disruption of the market as early success proves constraining. K E Y W O R D S competition, internal fit, market disruption, market positioning, NK model 1 |

 Giustiziero - Strategic search Adaptation of internal fit and market positioning under competi.pdf

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3. Interface as a design choice: How the implementation of interfaces influences coordination and performance in modular systems

Authors: Daniel Albert, Martin Ganco
DOI: 10.1002/smj.70121
Published: 2026-09-02

Keywords: agent-based model, ecosystems, innovation management, interdependence, interfaces, modular systems, platforms

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Strategic Management, Innovation Management, Organizational Design, Platform Ecosystems
- **Theories:** Modularity Theory, Coordination Theory, Design Rules, Search Theory

Abstract:

Research Summary: Modular systems play a central role in technological innovation. Such systems emerge when interdependencies among modules in a complex system are isolated through interfaces. While early sem- inal work highlighted the importance of interface design, subsequent research on modularity has largely overlooked it. We develop a model that treats interfaces as a set of design choices, separate from module choices. This model elucidates the mechanisms through which interface design influences system performance and identifies novel strategies for sequencing the search of interface and module designers to improve out- comes. The framework has implications not only for standalone innovations but also for the design of stan- dards in platforms and ecosystems. Ultimately, it dem- onstrates that interface design is as much a strategic challenge as it is a technical one. Received: 5 December 2023 Revised: 8 June 2026 Accepted: 24 July 2026 DOI: 10.1002/smj.70121 This is an open access article under the terms of the Creative Commons Attribution License, which permits use, distribution and reproduction in any medium, provided the original work is properly cited. © 2026 The Author(s). Strategic Management Journal published by John Wiley & Sons Ltd.

Strat Mgmt J. 2026;1–31. wileyonlinelibrary.com/journal/smj 1 Managerial Summary: Managers increasingly rely on modular designs to enable innovation, yet often over- look interfaces as a strategic lever. This study shows that actively designed and periodically updated inter- faces can coordinate interdependencies without con- straining decentralized search, enabling modular systems to approach the performance of integrated designs. Crucially, sequencing matters: allowing mod- ules to evolve before introducing interfaces improves long-run performance, as early experimentation gener- ates knowledge that interfaces can later build upon. Finally, infrequent interface redesign is sufficient to sustain coordination, reducing the need for continuous adaptations. Overall, interfaces should be treated as evolving strategic choices that shape innovation trajec- tories in products, platforms, and ecosystems. K E Y W O R D S agent-based model, ecosystems, innovation management, interdependence, interfaces, modular systems, platforms 1 |

Albert - Interface as a design choice How the implementation of interfaces influences coo.pdf

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Administrative Science Quarterly

1. The Double-Failure Trap: Workers' Sensemaking as Insiders and Victims of Life-Threatening Organizational Wrongdoing

Authors: Elisa Giuliani, Andrew Spicer
DOI: 10.1177/00018392261468328
Published: 2026-09-03

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Organizational Theory, Business Ethics, Sociology of Work
- **Theories:** Sensemaking Theory, Institutional Theory, Organizational Wrongdoing

Abstract:

Workers in many industrial settings remain in jobs that expose them to life-threatening harm, occupying a dual position as insiders within the firm and victims of its consequences. We examine how workers make sense of organizational wrongdoing from this dual position, through an inductive study of the ILVA steel plant in Taranto, Italy, where public scandal revealed chronic toxic emissions. We find that workers' sensemaking cannot be explained by insider or victim status alone but, instead, emerges at their intersection. While external actors interpret as complicity workers' continued participation in the firm following the exposure of wrongdoing, workers frame remaining as a survival-oriented response to life-threatening harm, condemning the organization as the source of injury while depending on it for survival. At the same time, as workers fail to secure recognition as victims beyond the firm, they come to view institutional inaction in the face of their suffering as evidence of systemic abandonment and injustice. We theorize that these processes—survival-based resignation to continue working and perceived institutional abandonment—reinforce each other, creating a double-failure trap in which workers endure life-threatening harm not because they fail to recognize its dangers but because they no longer believe protection or escape is possible.

Giuliani - The Double-Failure Trap Workers' Sensemaking as Insiders and Victims of Life-Thr.pdf

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2. Myopic Expansions on Digital Platforms

Authors: Ahmadreza Mostajabi, Aldona Kapacinskaite, Keyvan Vakili
DOI: 10.1177/00018392261461268
Published: 2026-09-05

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Strategic Management, Digital Strategy, Platform Ecosystems
- **Theories:** Behavioral Theory of the Firm, Scaling Theory, Market Friction

Abstract:

Digitization has enabled modern firms to expand at unprecedented rates, but there are downsides to rapid expansion. Prior research has highlighted how digital platforms facilitate mass-market expansions by resolving frictions associated with market entry. Accordingly, various studies have emphasized the positive impact of market-friction reduction on aggregate market size and efficiency. In this article, we argue that the extreme resolution of frictions may also have a downside: It can nudge platform participants to overlook the heterogeneous nature of different markets and, consequently, to engage in large-scale, potentially myopic market expansions. These expansions, in turn, may engender lower customer satisfaction and firm performance. We test our arguments in the context of Apple's App Store. We find that apps that undergo rapid, large-scale market expansions, relative to apps that do not expand or that expand more gradually, see a short-run increase in client base but longer-run declines in ratings, downloads, financial performance, and innovation. By addressing the underexplored negative side of resolving market frictions on platforms, the study advances knowledge of digital strategy and scaling.

 Mostajabi - Myopic Expansions on Digital Platforms.pdf

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3. Legitimizing the Regulatory State: How Institutional Intermediaries Facilitate Inclusive and Effective Co-creation in Emerging Economies

Authors: Allen Hicken, Edmund J. Malesky, Songkhun "Sunny" Nillasithanukroh, Markus Taussig
DOI: 10.1177/00018392261473620
Published: 2026-09-07

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Strategic Management, Non-market Strategy, International Business, Institutional Theory
- **Theories:** Procedural Justice, Institutional Intermediation, Legitimacy Theory, Co-creation

Abstract:

Theory indicates that inclusive regulatory co-creation between firms and their governments activates a procedural justice mechanism that improves firms' views of state legitimacy and leads to rules that better fit the full spectrum of real-world operating conditions. Emerging economies, however, face what we argue is a legitimacy–co-creation paradox: Widely held baseline views of government as corrupt and captured by elite interests lead many firms to balk at engaging with the state, thereby impeding opportunities for mutually beneficial co-creation. To address this challenge, we pilot and test the impact of a third-party intervention that we name the RegRoom, wherein an expert helps firms refine their comments on draft regulation before submitting them and, in so doing, increases the firms' understanding of the regulation's public purpose. We hypothesize and find evidence through a field experiment in Thailand that this institutional intermediation improves firms' perceptions of state legitimacy and observable engagement in regulatory co-creation. Further exploration of our data leads us to theorize a sequence by which institutional intermediaries overcome the legitimacy–co-creation paradox; specifically, legitimacy deficits need to be addressed before capability enhancement can occur. Our study shows how institutional intermediaries can contribute to the expansion of fairer and more-sustainable markets.

 Hicken - Legitimizing the Regulatory State How Institutional Intermediaries Facilitate In.pdf

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4. Cold Starts and Burning Desires: Reputation System Misalignment and Late-Career Transitions to Platform Work

Authors: Sienna Helena Parker-Waldern, Paul M. Leonardi
DOI: 10.1177/00018392261464889
Published: 2026-09-05

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Entrepreneurship, Organizational Theory, Platform Economy
- **Theories:** Algorithmic Management, Career Transition Theory, Reputation Systems

Abstract:

Workers face a cold start when entering new work contexts in which their reputations do not precede them. Cold starts are a particularly challenging problem for late-career workers who leave decades-long careers in formal organizations to pursue freelancing through online labor platforms. Unlike early- and mid-career freelancers, who are typically motivated by long-term career advancement, late-career workers are motivated to make work less central to their lives, although many still want and need to engage in paid labor in retirement. However, the question of how late-career workers navigate the cold-start problem is not well understood. In our study, we examine how late-career workers (55+ years old, 30+ years of work experience) manage the transition to platform-based freelancing. We find that for these workers, the cold-start problem is especially challenging as it is underpinned by reputation system misalignment, a clash between fundamentally different regimes for evaluating, recognizing, and assigning workers' value. Although late-career workers expected their credentials to confer credibility in platform work, overcoming the cold-start problem required recalibrating their motivations and sense of professional worth. Our findings advance theoretical conversations on algorithmic management and visibility, career transitions to platform work, and retirement.

Parker-Waldern - Cold Starts and Burning Desires Reputation System Misalignment and Late-Career Transitions to Platform Work.pdf

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Academy of Management Journal

1. The Role of Emotions in Engendering Commitment to an Organizational Purpose

Authors: Matthew Hurst, Davide Nicolini, Rene Wiedner
DOI: 10.5465/amj.2024.0294
Published: 2026-09-08

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Strategic Management, Organizational Behavior, Top Management Teams
- **Theories:** Emotional Dynamics, Commitment Theory, Organizational Purpose

Abstract:

Creating a compelling organizational purpose that motivates employees and resonates with stakeholders is a key responsibility of top management teams (TMTs). While much is known about how TMTs seek employee commitment, little is understood about the exact process through which TMTs develop and commit to an organizational purpose themselves. In this ethnographic study, we examine and theorize the mechanisms that promote the emergence of commitment to an organizational purpose for those who craft it. Through analysis of both successful and failed instances of facilitated purpose creation in companies across various industries, we show that emotional dynamics play a central role in the process. Diverging from traditional perspectives, we highlight the importance of negative emotions and the crucial role of coexisting conflicting positive and negative emotions. We also demonstrate that maintaining discomfort by preventing premature closure, carefully managing emotional transitions, and strategically using timing, spacing, and materiality can significantly enhance the emergence of commitment.

Hurst - The Role of Emotions in Engendering Commitment to an Organizational Purpose.pdf

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2. Firm Speed and Environmental Accidents

Authors: Toby X. Li
DOI: 10.5465/amj.2024.0689
Published: 2026-09-02

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Strategic Management, Operations Management, Environmental Management
- **Theories:** Time Compression Diseconomies, Competitive Advantage, Resource-Based View

Abstract:

Firms can achieve competitive advantage by performing activities faster than rivals, but less understood is

how firm speed impacts the environment. This study examines the inherent environmental consequences associated with this key source of competitive advantage in strategy. The basic premise is that pressing operations to go faster, which creates time compression diseconomies, is associated with more environmental accidents. Firm and labor market factors that mitigate the speed–accidents trade-off are examined—specifically, greater adoption of automation and exposure to thicker labor markets—which drive firm heterogeneity in this relationship and explain how some firms compete with speed while minimizing environmental harm. Support is found for these ideas using fine-grained data from oil and gas drilling projects in Pennsylvania.

 Li - Firm Speed and Environmental Accidents.pdf

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3. Resolving the Performance Feedback Puzzle: CEO Psychopathy, Heterogeneous Emotional Responses to Aspiration Gaps, and Risk-Taking

Authors: Remzi Gözübüyük, Steffen Burkert, Aino Tenhiälä, Carl J. Kock, Jukka Partanen
DOI: 10.5465/amj.2024.1013
Published: 2026-08-31

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Strategic Management, Behavioral Strategy, Corporate Governance
- **Theories:** Behavioral Theory of the Firm, Threat-Rigidity Theory, Trait Activation Theory, Performance Feedback Theory

Abstract:

Theoretical perspectives provide conflicting predictions regarding how firms adjust risk-taking in response to performance–aspiration gaps. The behavioral theory of the firm attributes increased risk-taking to problemistic search under negative gaps, whereas threat–rigidity theory predicts a reduction in risk-taking. Under positive gaps, the behavioral theory of the firm' s satisficing logic implies decreased risk-taking, while slack search theory indicates the opposite effect. We integrate these competing theoretical logics through trait activation theory by introducing CEO psychopathy as a source of heterogeneity in responses to performance feedback. We argue that performance–aspiration gaps function as situational cues that activate differences in CEOs' sensitivity to threat and reward cues, generating distinct emotional responses. The relationship between performance–aspiration gaps and risk-taking shifts from negative at lower levels of CEO psychopathy to positive at higher levels. Using fixed effects models on a longitudinal dataset of Finnish firms and a population-scale psychometric measure of CEO psychopathy collected independently of firm outcomes, we find empirical support for these predictions. Our theory reconceptualizes satisficing, threat–rigidity, problemistic search, and slack search as conditionally activated behavioral regimes rather than competing predictions tied solely to the valence of the performance–aspiration gap.

 Gözübüyük - Resolving the Performance Feedback Puzzle CEO Psychopathy, Heterogeneous Emotion.pdf

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Academy of Management Review

1. Out with the Old, in with the New? A Response to "How AI Reshapes Multimodal Theorization"

Authors: Ines Kuric, Markus A. Höllerer
DOI: 10.5465/amr.2026.0703
Published: 2026-09-14

Abstract not available. Kuric - Out with the Old, in with the New A Response to How AI Reshapes Multimodal Theorization.pdf

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2. Understanding Institutional Environments: A Reply to Two Dialogues from Schultz & Valentinov and Mikel-Hong

Authors: Patricia H. Thornton, Juan (“John”) Almandoz
DOI: 10.5465/amr.2026.0759
Published: 2026-09-04

Abstract not available. Thornton - Understanding Institutional Environments A Reply to Two Dialogues from Schultz &.pdf

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3. Close Friends, Closer Comparisons: Regulating Envy in Multiplex Relationships

Authors: Amnah Ameen, Alexandra Rheinhardt Beer, Kyoungjo (Jo) Oh
DOI: 10.5465/amr.2024.0114
Published: 2026-08-31

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Organizational Behavior, Social Psychology
- **Theories:** Emotion Regulation Theory, Social Comparison Theory, Multiplex Relationships

Abstract:

Workplace envy is a socially embedded experience with important personal and relational implications. Yet, not all workplace relationships provide the same context for experiencing and regulating envy. In contemporary organizations, work is increasingly carried out within multiplex relationships that span both professional and personal domains. These relationships broaden the dimensions along which social comparisons occur and heighten the self-relevance of others’ successes, advantages, and favorable life circumstances, making envy especially likely. At the same time, friendship obligations, professional norms, and ongoing work responsibilities can constrain how envy is managed and expressed. Drawing upon emotion regulation theory and research on workplace relationships, we develop a theoretical model that explains how individuals regulate envy within multiplex relationships. We argue that envy simultaneously makes salient personal and relational motives—the desire to reduce the sting of envy and the desire to preserve a valued workplace relationship. These motives, in turn, activate a dual-motive appraisal process through which individuals arrive at key decision points that culminate in one of three regulatory pathways—experience-, situation-, or expression-level regulation—with each pathway producing distinct emotional and relational trajectories. In laying out this model, we seek to advance research on workplace envy and multiplex relationships.

Ameen - Close Friends, Closer Comparisons Regulating Envy in Multiplex Relationships.pdf

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Organization Science

1. Social Performance Feedback and Managerial Moral Self-Regulation: The Microfoundations of Corporate Social (Ir)Responsibility

Authors: Benjamin G. Perkins, Yilin Liu, Songcui Hu, Cuili Qian, Sarah Doyle
DOI: 10.1287/orsc.2024.19440
Published: 2026-09-08

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Strategic Management, Corporate Social Responsibility, Behavioral Strategy, Microfoundations
- **Theories:** Behavioral Theory of the Firm, Moral Self-Regulation Theory

Abstract:

Despite growing interest in the microfoundations of corporate social activities, prior research has not articulated the full chain connecting firm-level conditions to managers’ psychological processes (a top-down

pathway) and back to firm-level corporate social behavior (a bottom-up pathway), leaving existing microfoundational accounts incomplete. Drawing on the behavioral theory of the firm and moral self-regulation theory, we develop a crosslevel moral feedback model that integrates both pathways by linking firm-level social performance feedback, individual-level managerial cognition, and firm-level corporate social responsibility (CSR) and corporate social irresponsibility (CSI). We argue that social performance feedback activates managers' moral self-regulation. When a firm falls below its social performance aspiration, its managers perceive a diminished firm image, which undermines their moral self-image and triggers moral cleansing behaviors—manifested as increased CSR and/or reduced CSI. Conversely, when a firm exceeds its social performance aspiration, its managers perceive an enhanced firm image, which elevates their moral self-image and activates moral licensing behaviors—manifested as reduced CSR and/or increased CSI. Study 1 uses archival data to examine the main effects of firms' social performance feedback on CSR and CSI. Study 2 uses a series of experiments to examine the proposed microlevel mechanisms, demonstrating how managers' perceived firm image and moral self-image sequentially mediate the effects of social performance feedback on CSR and CSI. These studies provide complementary evidence for our multilevel behavioral model. Our study contributes to research on the microfoundations of corporate social activities, behavioral strategy, and moral self-regulation. Funding: The authors acknowledge financial support for this research from the University of Arizona's Center for Leadership Ethics. Supplemental Material: The online appendix is available at https://doi.org/10.1287/orsc.2024.19440 .

Perkins - Social Performance Feedback and Managerial Moral Self-Regulation The Microfound

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2. Fit to Print? How Political Bias Affects Media Coverage of Corporate Sociopolitical Activism

Authors: Farhan Iqbal, Michael D. Pfarrer, Abhinav Gupta
DOI: 10.1287/orsc.2025.20084
Published: 2026-09-08

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Strategic Management, Corporate Sociopolitical Activism, Media Studies, Organizational Political Ideology
- **Theories:** Ideological Differentiation, Bias Allocation Framework

Abstract:

Organizational research has largely treated media coverage of firms as insulated from news outlets' political biases, implicitly assuming that it provides a balanced representation of firm behaviors. However, increasing political polarization and firms' growing involvement in social and political controversies challenge this assumption by creating greater scope for news outlets' political orientations to shape business reporting. We explore this possibility by developing a two-stage framework that discerns news outlets' attention (i.e., what firm behaviors they cover) from their tone (i.e., how they portray those behaviors). We argue that media organizations face two competing pressures: an incentive to cultivate ideological differentiation that appeals to readers and an incentive to maintain credibility that appeals to advertisers. We find that ideological congruence between a news outlet's political orientation and a firm's behavior increases the likelihood that the behavior receives coverage but does not influence the evaluative tone of that coverage—a pattern we term bias allocation. Supplemental analyses also reveal ideological asymmetries across left- and right-leaning outlets. We conclude by discussing the implications of our findings for research on the media, organizational political ideology, and strategic management. Supplemental Material: The online appendix is available at https://doi.org/10.1287/orsc.2025.20084 .

Iqbal - Fit to Print How Political Bias Affects Media Coverage of Corporate Sociopolitic

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3. Staying Alive! Entrepreneurial Human Capital and Resilience of New Ventures

Authors: Pontus Braunerhjelm, Emma Lappi
DOI: 10.1287/orsc.2023.17457
Published: 2026-08-31

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Entrepreneurship, Human Capital, Organizational Resilience
- **Theories:** Human Capital Theory, Resource-Based View, Organizational Fit

Abstract:

Survival of new ventures has been shown to exhibit considerable heterogeneity both across and within industries. Some of the explanations for these differences have been attributed to firm size, organizational structure, and management practices. We add to this literature by showing how differences in employees' abilities and their knowledge domain relate to survival. More precisely, we focus on the role of employees who in the past started and managed firms, referred to as an organization' s entrepreneurial human capital (EHC). Theoretically, we adopt an eclectic approach, while the empirical analysis is based on longitudinal register data for Sweden from 1997 to 2016. This allows us to identify EHC for all new ventures over the past 20 years. After controlling for a large number of confounders, our baseline results strongly suggest that a higher share of employees with entrepreneurial backgrounds is associated with an increased probability of new venture survival. We identify the following mechanisms through which former entrepreneurs contribute to survival: an enlarged resource base, magnified by learning from longer spells in entrepreneurship; an organizational fit conducive to absorbing and utilizing EHC; and a human capital fit in which entrepreneurial competencies align with the competence requirements of new ventures. We argue that our findings have both theoretical and practical implications for recruiters and managers and provide valuable insights for policymakers. Funding: This work was supported by Swedish Research Council for Sustainable Development (FORMAS) [Grant 2022-01288]. Supplemental Material: The online appendix is available at https://doi.org/10.1287/orsc.2023.17457 .

 Braunerhjelm - Staying Alive! Entrepreneurial Human Capital and Resilience of New Ventures.pdf

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Innovation & Entrepreneurship

Entrepreneurship Theory and Practice

1. Are All Patents Equal? How Patent Attributes Shape Market Reactions to Family and Nonfamily Firm Innovation

Authors: Kimberly A. Eddleston, Francesco Chirico, Pankaj C. Patel
DOI: 10.1177/10422587261470045
Published: 2026-09-08

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Strategic Management, Innovation Management, Family Business
- **Theories:** Signaling Theory, Market Reactions, Innovation Attributes

Abstract:

Integrating family firm innovation research with signaling theory, we develop a framework explaining market reactions to patents granted to family versus nonfamily firms. Using a U.S. dataset of 52,241 patents from 2014 to 2018, we find the stock market reacts more positively to patents granted to family firms than nonfamily firms. We then examine reactions to radical versus incremental patents. Patents reflecting radical innovation, measured by novelty and pedi- gree, create greater market value for family firms than nonfamily firms, although the pedigree effect is only marginally significant. By contrast, patents reflecting incremental innovation, mea- sured by temporal depth, have little effect on nonfamily firms' market value but reduce family firms' market value.

 Eddleston - Are All Patents Equal How Patent Attributes Shape Market Reactions to Family and.pdf

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Strategic Entrepreneurship Journal

1. Caught in the framing: How consumer reactivity links typicality and market appeal for creative products

Authors: Guang Zhu, Tao Wang, Xiaofei Qu
DOI: 10.1002/sej.70044
Published: 2026-09-13

Keywords: categories, consumer reactivity, creative products, framing, natural language processing, typicality

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Strategic Management, Entrepreneurship, Category Studies, Creative Industries
- **Theories:** Category Theory, Social Evaluation, Consumer Reactivity, Framing

Abstract:

Research Summary: While consumers' perceptions of creative products' framing typicality are guided by existing category structures, research on social evaluation empha- sizes consumers' active role in shaping and redefining these structures. To tackle consumers being caught in the framing, we propose consumer reactivity as a mediator between framing typicality and market appeal, defined as consumers' extension and modification of categorical guidance in social evaluations. Specifically, we suggest that creative products with less typical framings elicit greater consumer reactivity, which in turn enhances their market appeal. Empirical ana- lyses of a unique dataset of games on Steam using BERT- based measures, topic modeling, and psycholinguistic analy- sis (LIWC) lend support to our theoretical arguments. Our work contributes to creative market studies and the cate- gory literature. Managerial Summary: Consumers typically rely on category cues, so products that fit expectations often seem more appealing. However, they also actively engage with prod- ucts, exploring features that don't fit categorical expecta- tions. We show that consumer reactivity explains this dynamic: creative products with less typical framings Received: 31 January 2025 Revised: 13 August 2026 Accepted: 17 August 2026 DOI: 10.1002/sej.70044 © 2026 Strategic Management Society. All rights reserved, including rights for text and data mining and training of artificial intelligence technologies or similar technologies. Strategic Entrepreneurship Journal. 2026;1–38. wileyonlinelibrary.com/journal/sej 1 generate stronger engagement, which in turn boosts market appeal. Our analyses of a unique Steam game dataset using BERT-based measures, topic modeling, and psycholinguistic analysis (LIWC) support this pattern. For practitioners, the key insight is to acknowledge the potential of seemingly less-fit products. By thoughtfully monitoring consumer interests and initiatives and cultivating their engagement, creative producers can enhance the market performance of creative products. K E Y W O R D S categories, consumer reactivity, creative products, framing, natural language processing, typicality 1 |

 Zhu - Caught in the framing How consumer reactivity links typicality and market appeal.pdf

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2. Women own differently: How women's decision-making authority shapes owner teams' strategic choices in private firms

Authors: Jannis von Nitzsch, Miriam Bird
DOI: 10.1002/sej.70043
Published: 2026-09-01

Keywords: risk taking, social role theory, strategic choices, strategic ownership, value-creation orientations

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Strategic Management, Entrepreneurship, Corporate Governance, Women's Entrepreneurship
- **Theories:** Social Role Theory, Strategic Ownership, Decision-making Authority

Abstract:

Research Summary: The literature on the strategic role of ownership in creating firm value suggests that owners' ulti- mate decision-making authority allows them to align their firms' strategic orientations with

their idiosyncratic judg- ment. By integrating the strategic ownership literature with social role theory, we theorize how women owners' gender- based judgment influences owner teams' strategic choices depending on the level of ownership (i.e., decision-making authority) collectively held by women owners. Our empirical evidence, based on 42,667 European firms, suggests that greater ownership among women is associated with less risky strategic choices and a stronger social value-creation orientation among owner teams. These relationships are partly contingent on whether or not women hold a block majority. Our findings contribute to the strategic ownership literature and advance research on women's entrepreneurship. Managerial Summary: In this study, based on 42,667 European private firms led by owner teams, we investigate how women's ownership affects owner teams' strategic choices. Consistent with established behavioral differences between men and women, we find that greater decision- making authority held by women owners is associated with less risky strategic choices and a stronger social value- Received: 16 February 2024 Revised: 30 July 2026 Accepted: 11 August 2026 DOI: 10.1002/sej.70043 This is an open access article under the terms of the Creative Commons Attribution License, which permits use, distribution and reproduction in any medium, provided the original work is properly cited. © 2026 The Author(s). Strategic Entrepreneurship Journal published by John Wiley & Sons Ltd on behalf of Strategic Management Society. Strategic Entrepreneurship Journal. 2026;1–29. wileyonlinelibrary.com/journal/sej 1 creation orientation among owner teams. These associa- tions, to varying extents, are contingent on whether or not women on the team collectively hold a block majority. Our findings help owner teams reflect on how the gender com- position of their teams and the distribution of decision- making authority among owners jointly shape strategic choices. We also provide investors with new insights into how different ownership structures ultimately influence firms' broader strategic orientations. K E Y W O R D S risk taking, social role theory, strategic choices, strategic ownership, value-creation orientations 1 |

 Nitzsch - Women own differently How women's decision-making authority shapes owner teams'.pdf

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General Management

Journal of Management Studies

1. Beyond the Management Gene: Rethinking and Advancing the Genetic Perspective in Management

Authors: Ahmed Maged Nofal, Marcus Wolfe
DOI: 10.1111/joms.70160
Published: 2026-09-13

Keywords: biology, entrepreneurship, genetics, leadership, management

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Organizational Behavior, Entrepreneurship, Leadership, Management Theory
- **Theories:** Genetic Perspective, Gene-Environment Interaction, Biological Foundations of Management

Abstract:

Abstract Genetics has emerged as a promising avenue for explaining differences in management outcomes, attracting attention from leadership, entrepreneurship, and organizational behaviour scholars. Nonetheless, the field has faced scepticism and made only limited progress, stagnating in the pursuit of a so-called 'management gene' (e.g., leadership gene and entrepreneurial gene). We argue that framing research around the search for a management gene has been theoretically limiting and empirically counterproductive, and that the genetic perspective could realize its promise through a nuanced understanding of how genetics relate to management outcomes. Drawing on five core genetic concepts (penetrance, phenocopy, polygenicity, pleiotropy, and epigenetics), we develop a framework comprising three intertwined stages that organize genetic methods according to their inferential strength. The stages focus on establishing whether genetic variance exists, identifying where it resides, and explaining when and why genetic predispositions become organizationally expressed. In doing so, the framework reframes non-detections as theoretically informative, revealing when and why genetic predispositions go unexpressed. It thus turns what were previously seen as dead ends into evidence that advances theory. It positions gene–environment relationships as a

core theoretical concern, redirecting the field away from the search for a management gene and towards understanding why individuals produce divergent outcomes.

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2. Reimagining Interdisciplinarity: Sensitization, Reflexivity, and Mobilization Across Landscapes of Practice

Authors: Ryan Nolan, Frank Siedlok, Paul Hibbert
DOI: 10.1111/joms.70158
Published: 2026-09-11

Keywords: collaboration, interdisciplinarity, landscapes of practice, practice theory

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Organizational Theory, Management Studies, Knowledge Management
- **Theories:** Practice Theory, Landscapes of Practice, Reflexivity

Abstract:

Abstract Interdisciplinary research (IDR) is widely promoted as essential for addressing complex societal challenges, yet its enactment remains fraught. We argue that dominant typological and structural approaches miscast IDR and underplay the practical work through which it unfolds. Drawing on practice theory, we reconceptualize IDR as bundles of practices enacted across landscapes of practice. We theorize three guiding constructs: sensitization, reflexivity, and mobilization that support the coordination of IDR without collapsing its ontological multiplicity through misplaced attempts at epistemological integration. A practice lens clarifies why structural and typological interventions supply conditions that support IDR but do not guarantee outcomes; foregrounds the fragility, temporality, and politics of doing IDR; and reframes evaluation around practices rather than proxy measures such as bibliometrics. We outline implications for organizing and leading IDR and a research agenda linking IDR to wider debates in management and organization studies. Our contribution shifts attention from what IDR is to how it is enacted, sustained, and sometimes unravelled in practice.

 Nolan - Reimagining Interdisciplinarity Sensitization, Reflexivity, and Mobilization Acr.pdf

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3. The Narrative Construction of Internal Organizational Legitimacy

Authors: Kerrie E. Howard, Andrew D. Brown
DOI: 10.1111/joms.70155
Published: 2026-09-10

Keywords: internal legitimacy, myth, narrative, organizational contradiction

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Organizational Theory, Organizational Behavior, Corporate Communications
- **Theories:** Narrative Perspective, Organizational Legitimacy, Myth-making

Abstract:

Abstract
Organizations torn by significant contradictions may struggle to maintain internal legitimacy. Taking a narrative perspective, and drawing on a case study of Walgreens, a Fortune 500 retail pharmacy, we develop a process model that shows how organizations with an entrenched conflict in their official narratives manage the resulting polyphony of members' personal narratives through the development of myths that sustain internal legitimacy by making the contradiction 'liveable'. The model reveals how myths that represent contradictions as temporary and project a future in which they will be satisfactorily resolved help people to cope with inconsistencies in processes of organizing and support the status quo. Our theorizing sug-

gests that internal legitimacy is constituted by the narratives that individuals author about the desirability, propriety, and appropriateness of their organization and its practices. From a narratological perspective, rather than existing on a continuum from high to low and being a resource that can be stockpiled, internal legitimacy may be theorized as a polyphony of distinctive narratives that while discursively dynamic is also generally durable.

 Howard - The Narrative Construction of Internal Organizational Legitimacy.pdf

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4. Who Are You Hanging Out With? The Conditional Importance of Investment Managers' Personal Reputation in the Formation of Venture Capital Syndication Ties

Authors: Massimo G. Colombo, Annalisa Croce, Elisa Ughetto
DOI: 10.1111/joms.70156
Published: 2026-09-08

Keywords: professional relationships, reputation, syndication, venture capital managers

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Entrepreneurship, Entrepreneurial Financing, Venture Capital
- **Theories:** Signaling Theory, Network Theory, Social Capital

Abstract:

Abstract We examine how the two dimensions of VC managers' personal reputation, that is, 'being known' and 'being known for quality', jointly influence the formation of initial syndication ties. We propose that VC managers follow a two-stage cognitive process. In the first stage, the 'being known for quality' dimension – a reflection of their abilities-must enter their 'consideration set'. The 'being known' dimension is crucial to draw attention to potential candidates. In the second stage, lead VC managers evaluate the signal conveyed by the 'being known for quality' dimension of prospective partners' reputation. The 'being known' dimension is also important at this stage, as it allows for a more accurate assessment of what is otherwise a noisy signal. We test our hypotheses on a pairwise dataset of 1686 realized and 14,395 counterfactual initial syndication ties between VC managers. We find that lead VC managers are more likely to form initial syndication ties with VC managers with similar reputations. This effect is stronger if they share a previous common employer, have a similar industrial or geographic investment focus, or work at VC firms that have previously syndicated one or more investments with each other or with the same VC firm.

 Colombo - Who Are You Hanging Out With The Conditional Importance of Investment Managers' .pdf

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5. State De-Orchestration of Corporate Social Responsibility: The Backlash against CSR in Brazil under the Bolsonaro Government

Authors: Alan Brejnholt, Jukka Rintamäki, Gerhard Schnyder
DOI: 10.1111/joms.70147
Published: 2026-09-07

Keywords: Brazil, corporate discretion, CSR backlash, institutional infrastructure, state de-orchestration

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Strategic Management, Non-market Strategy, Corporate Social Responsibility
- **Theories:** Orchestration Theory, Institutional Theory, State-Business Interactions

Abstract:

Abstract
Governments have become increasingly active players in corporate social responsibility (CSR), with many countries adopting more stringent regulations for firms to pursue goals not limited to profit-making. However, more recently, some jurisdictions have seen a backlash against CSR, which implies that the state's role in CSR is reversing from facilitating, encouraging, and mandating to prohibiting or undermining CSR.

We study one such case of backlash against CSR in Bolsonaro's Brazil. We introduce the concept of state de-orchestration to capture the reversal of the government's role in CSR in Brazil. We contribute to processual perspectives on state-business interactions, the government and CSR literature, and the orchestration literature, by identifying the mechanisms by which the state loosens the constraints on and support for firms to pursue public good objectives. We also contribute to the government and CSR literature by demonstrating and theorising the impact de-orchestration has on corporate discretion. We argue that corporate discretion needs to be conceived as both the liberty to adopt or not adopt CSR practices and the ability to do so. We further show that for some firms, domestic de-orchestration may impair the exercise of corporate discretion, particularly among those exposed to pressures stemming from transnational CSR norms.

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Journal of Management

1. The Networks of Others: A Model of Secondhand Brokerage and its Effects on Employee Innovation

Authors: Rohit S. Piplani, Travis J. Grosser
DOI: 10.1177/01492063261480612
Published: 2026-09-07

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Organizational Behavior, Innovation Management, Social Network Analysis
- **Theories:** Network Theory, Secondhand Brokerage, Alter-centric Perspective

Abstract:

Social network research on creativity and innovation has primarily focused on the focal employee (i.e., ego), implicitly assuming that ego's own network position determines the resources available for creative work. We advance an alter-centric perspective, arguing that what matters is not merely the availability of diverse information but the capacity of network contacts (i.e., alters) to make it usable. The brokerage characteristics of ego's alters (i.e., sec ondhand brokerage) are decisive in that alters who are brokers are likely to have both valuable non-redundant information and the capability to convey it effectively. Prior work treating sec ondhand brokerage as a monolithic construct has yielded equivocal results; we reconcile these findings by decomposing it into distinct forms and matching each to the demands of a specific phase of the innovation process (i.e., idea generation, idea elaboration, idea championing, and idea implementation). We theorize that external secondhand brokerage facilitates idea genera tion, internal secondhand brokerage facilitates idea elaboration, internal alters' network oscil lation facilitates idea championing, and external alters' network oscillation facilitates idea implementation, with ego's knowledge integration capability, psychological ownership, organi zational status, professional status, and tie strength serving as phase-specific and cross-phase boundary conditions. In doing so, we also challenge the prevailing view of brokers as default opportunists, specifying when cooperation, rather than opportunism, is the more rational strat egy. By integrating the social network and innovation literatures, our framework clarifies how, when, and why the networks of others shape ego's success across the innovation process. Keywords: social networks; secondhand brokerage; employee creativity; idea elaboration; alter-centric perspective; innovation implementation

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